very useful ideas came up in these discussions, which sometimes took on the character of a university seminar, with argument and counter-argument. Unlike a university seminar, however, we needed decisions at the end of meetings! The meetings were also a way to keep all our senior staff abreast of important developments, and for them to have ownership of the reforms (both to the financial system and the RBI's internal functioning).

I got a chance to articulate our thinking on 15 November 2013 at the Bankcon Conference. I stressed five pillars around which our reform efforts were structured. This then became an easy way to explain our strategy to the many visitors we had, as well as to organize thinking within the RBI. In the speeches and texts that are reproduced here, I have edited the original text only to eliminate repetition or to improve clarity.

The Five Pillars of RBI's Financial Sector Policies

I want to focus on what we at the Reserve Bank are doing to improve the financial system. We plan to build the Reserve Bank's developmental measures over the next few quarters on five pillars. These are:

1. Clarifying and strengthening the monetary policy framework.
2. Strengthening banking structure through new entry, branch expansion, encouraging new varieties of banks, and moving foreign banks into better regulated organizational forms.
3. Broadening and deepening financial markets and increasing their liquidity and resilience so that they can help allocate and absorb the risks entailed in financing India's growth.
4. Expanding access to finance to small and medium enterprises, the unorganized sector, the poor, and remote and underserved areas of the country through technology, new